Nextcloud How-To

About

Nextcloud[1] is a self-hosted file storage system that is similar to commercial products such as OneDrive and Google Drive. Nextcloud can integrate with several other applications as configured by the server administrator. The CCDC Nextcloud server has enabled two applications in addition to files, Talk and Forms. Talk is a chat application, and Forms allows users to create/respond to standard form items like a survey. In the CCDC configuration Blue teams can only participate in Talk/Forms. White/Black/Green teams will be responsible for creation of any necessary chats.

Logging In

CCDC Docs is using Authentik[2] as the Identity Provider (IdP) for the competition. Blue team members should be given accounts prior to the start of the competition with a username like team01a. Blue team accounts will automatically be tied to a group for their team to limit access to only their group. White/Black/Green team members will have their own individual accounts, with some spares available for the day of the competition.

Users will need to go to https://docs.ccdc.events/ to bring up the login page for the first time. The login page should look like the following.



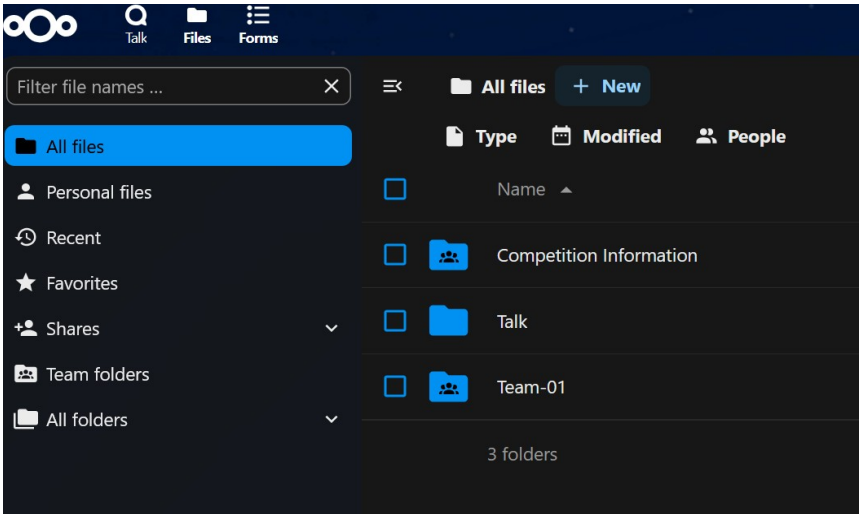
Once the user enters a valid username/password, they will be redirected to the Nextcloud user interface.

1 https://nextcloud.com/
2 https://goauthentik.io/

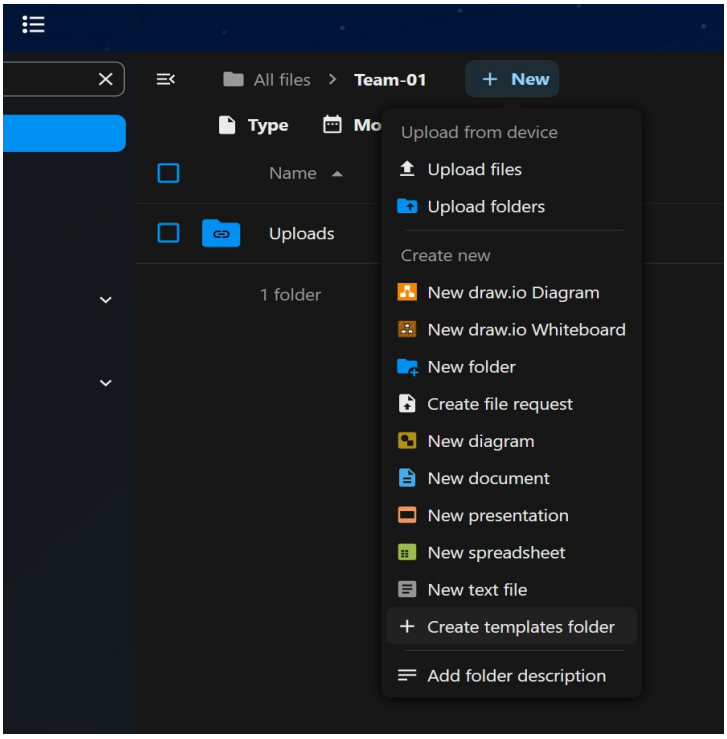
User Interface

In the top left corner the user will be shown three icons for Talk, Files, and Forms. If you hover over the icons you will see text descriptions. By default the user will be in the Files application. This application will show the user's personal files, as well as shares the user has access to.

- Competition Information: This folder is used for putting out competition wide information, such as a copy of the team pack.
- **Team-XX**: This folder contains documents that are shared with other members of the same Blue team. **This should be the primary folder used by all members of a Blue team**.

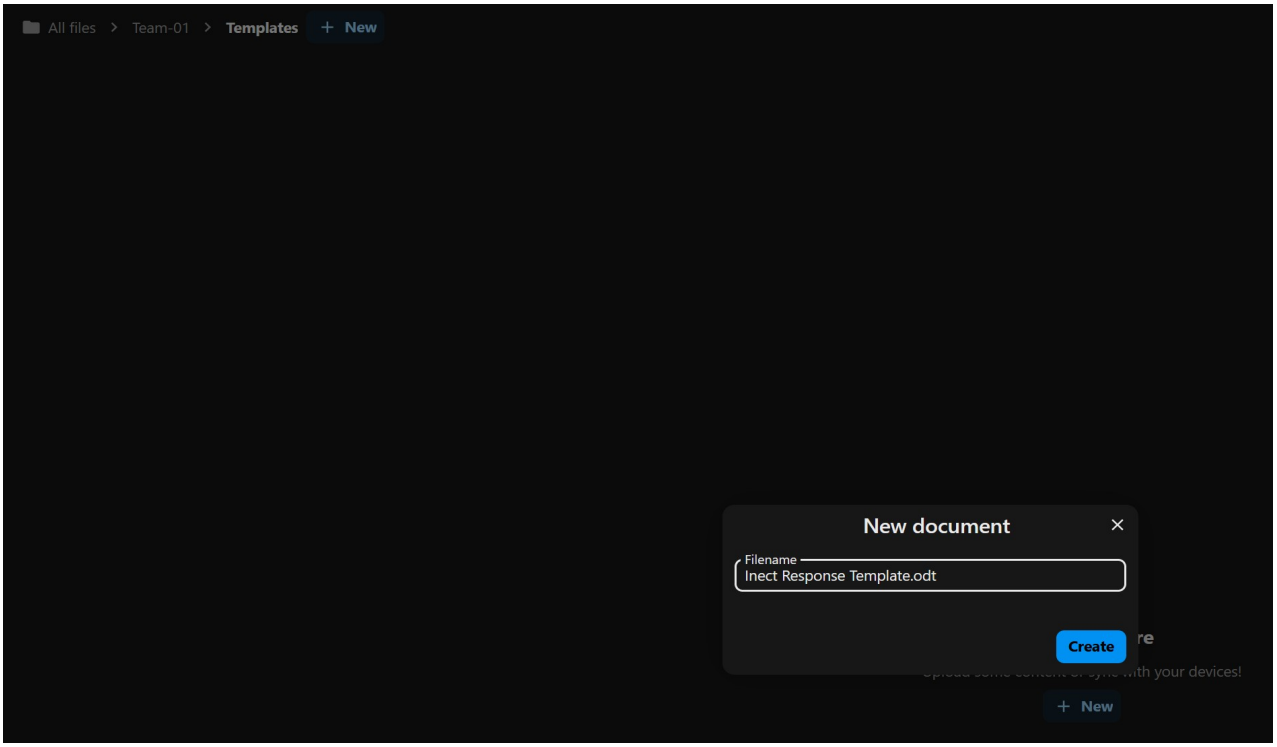


Users can create different types of documents using the "+ New" button at the top of the folder listing.

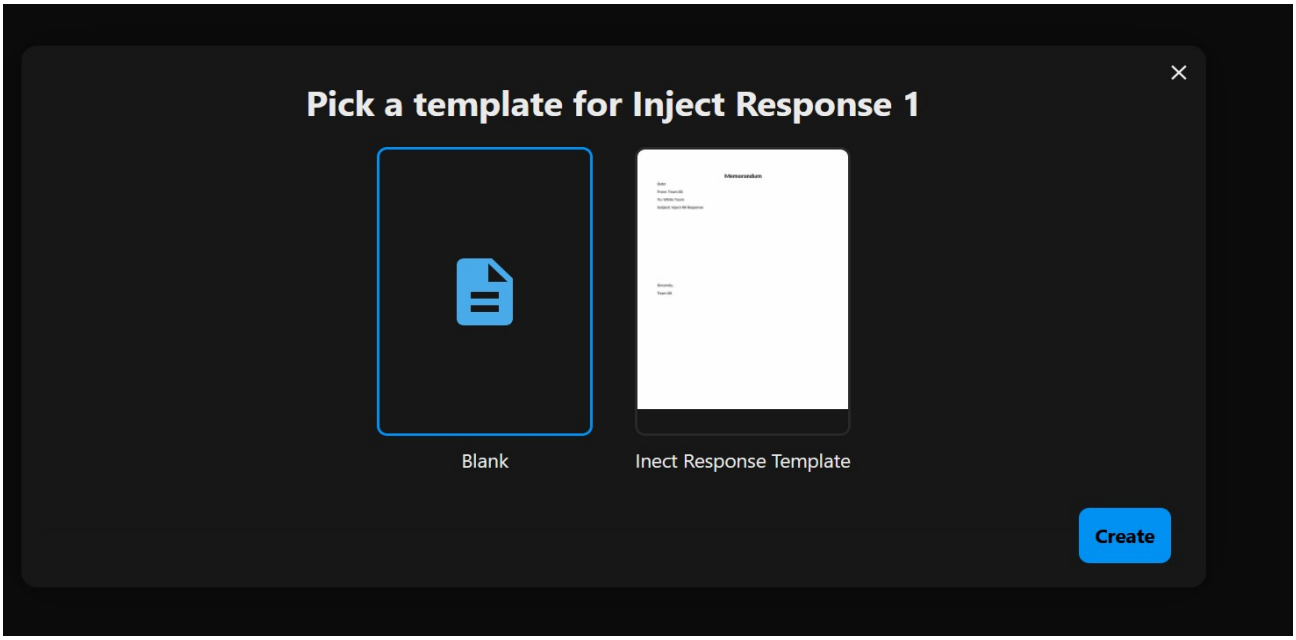


Templates Folder

Blue teams should initially create a templates folder, and create any documents within the templates folder that may be routinely used throughout the event. For example, an inject response template document. ***KNOWN ISSUE***: The templates only work for the user that initially created it. You can still copy the template document to a new document.

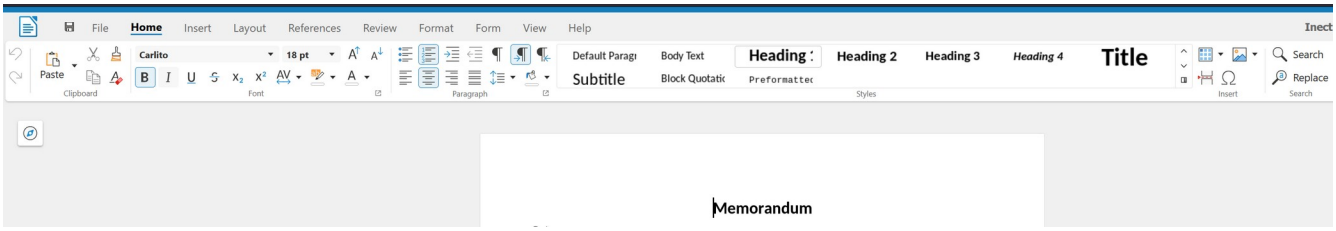


Once templates have been created, teams can return to their team folder and create a new document. The user will be prompted to create a blank document, or a copy of a template.



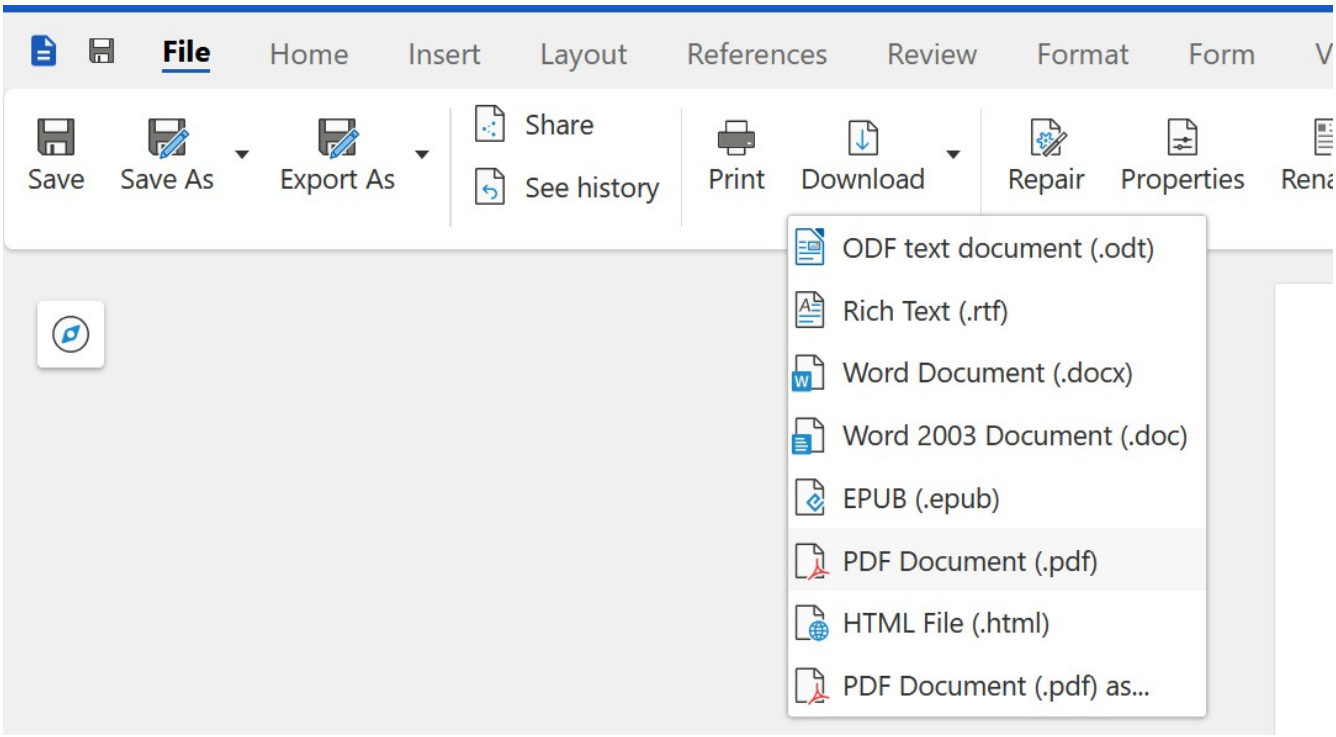
Editing Documents

When a user clicks on a document, it will open up within the web browser using a Collabora Online Development Environment (CODE)[3] server. The user interface is similar to that of LibreOffice[4]. Multiple users should be able to work on the same document together, in real time.



Saving as a PDF

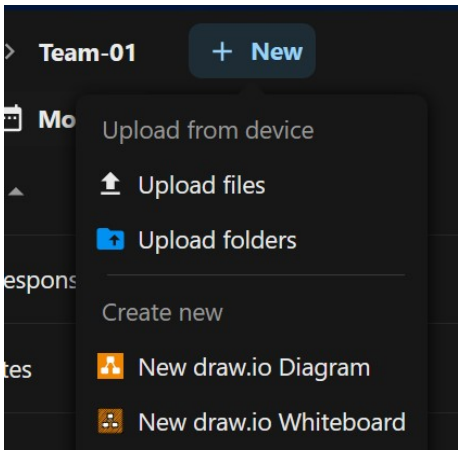
When editing a document, you can download a PDF copy by going to File, Download, PDF Document. This will download a PDF directly to your system, which you can then upload to the scoring engine as part of your inject response. ***KNOWN ISSUE***: Do not use the "Export As" function, as it does not seem to work reliably. Only use the download function to create the PDF document.

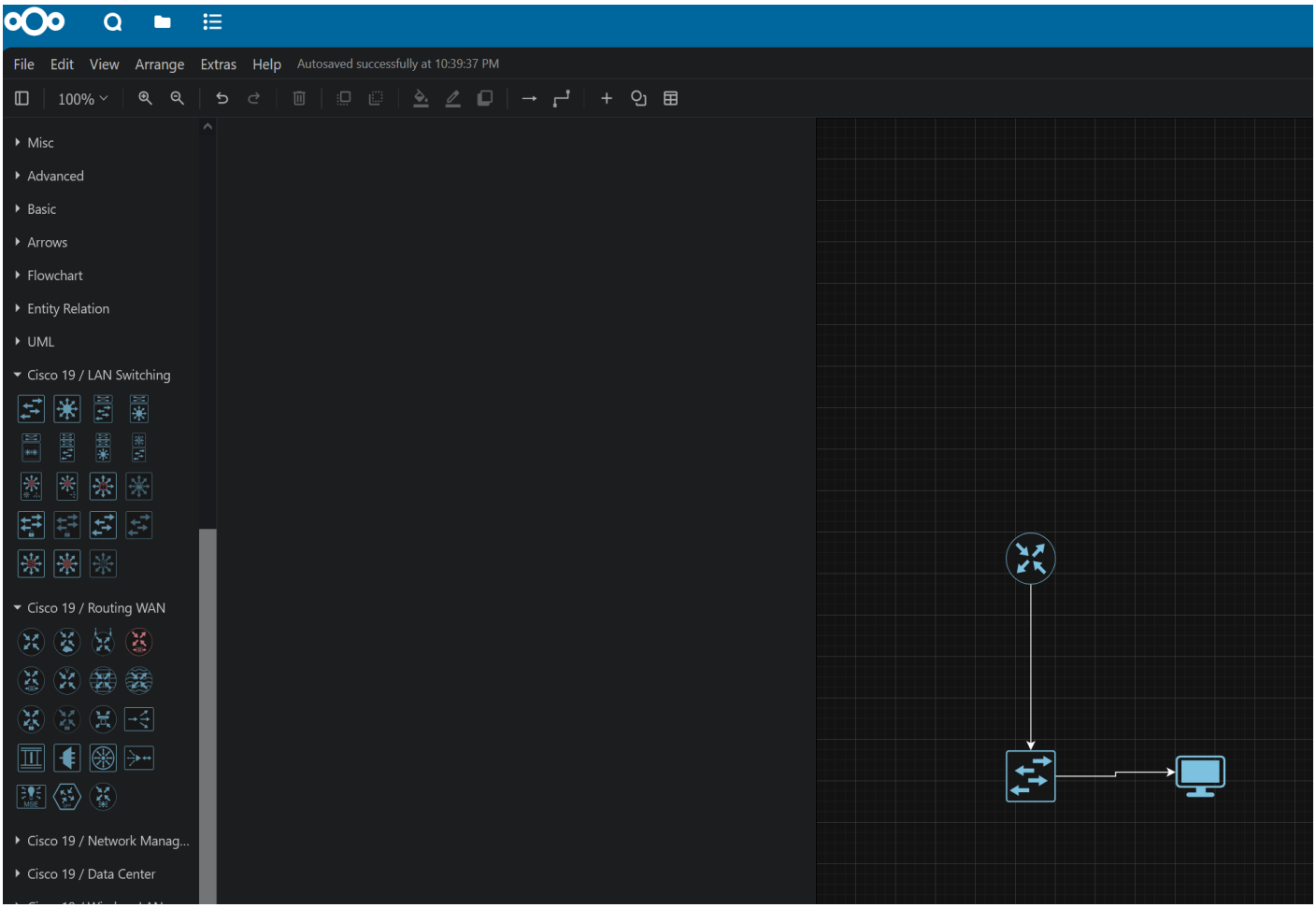


3 https://www.collaboraonline.com/code/
4 https://www.libreoffice.org/

Creating Diagrams

CCDC Docs has enabled integration with draw.io[5] to enable users to create diagrams within the web browser, and stored on the CCDC Docs server. Users can create a new diagram from the "+ New" icon. You can get additional shapes within draw.io by clicking on "+ More Shapes" on the bottom left.

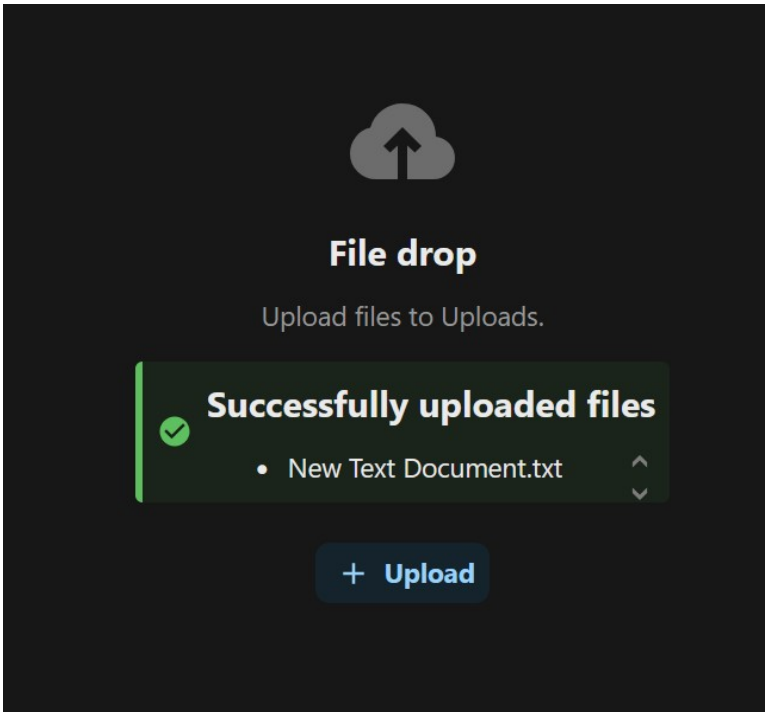


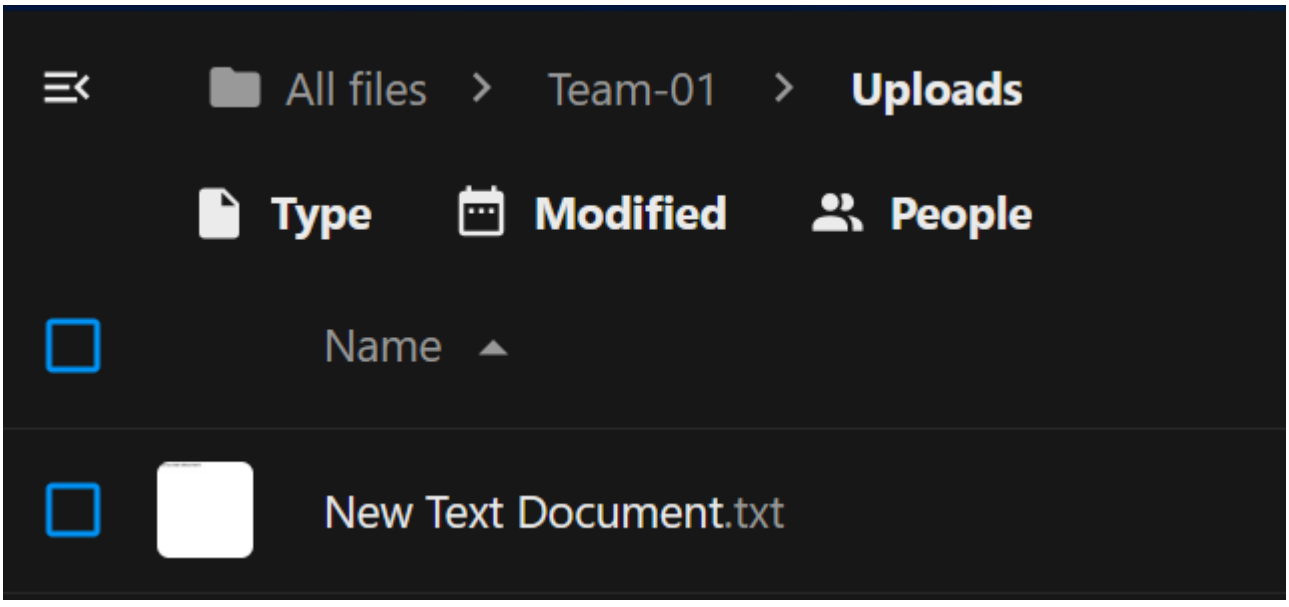


5 https://app.diagrams.net/

Uploading to CCDC Docs

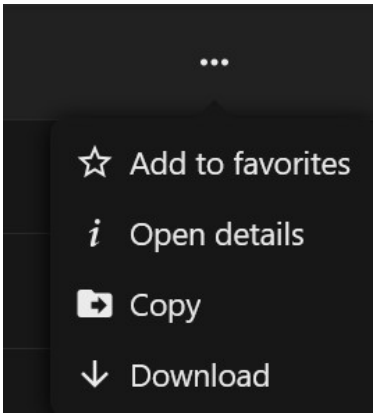
Blue teams will be given a short link unique to their team that will provide unauthenticated file upload only access to the “Uploads” folder within their team share. This link *should* be accessible from within the competition environment. This will allow competitors to upload items from within the environment to the CCDC Docs server. Files uploaded can not be edited/deleted from the uploads folder. Users will need to download the file to their local machine if they need to work on it, and can upload the modified version to their team folder.





Document Retention

Files created under Blue team folders will be backed up temporarily at the end of a competition in case they're needed for a dispute. All blue team accounts/files will be deleted from the server shortly after the close of an event. Should teams wish to retain their own copy of documents they can go to the root files, and click the "…" to the right of the Team-XX folder. They can then click Download to get a zip archive of the entire folder. This should be done near the end of an event, before blue team accounts/files are purged from the system.



Issues/Feedback

Issues with the CCDC Docs system should be communicated within the support chat if possible. If unable, please raise the issue through an out of bands method such as the competition Zoom. Feedback is always welcome, and should be directed towards Jimmy Murphy.

Thank You

We appreciate you trying out this new system! We hope it's beneficial to the teams competing in the event. If it proves useful, we'll work to continue to improve the system for future events.